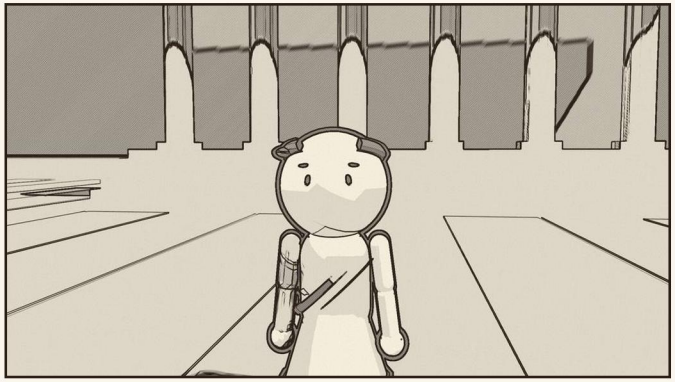
THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 0 COLD OPEN



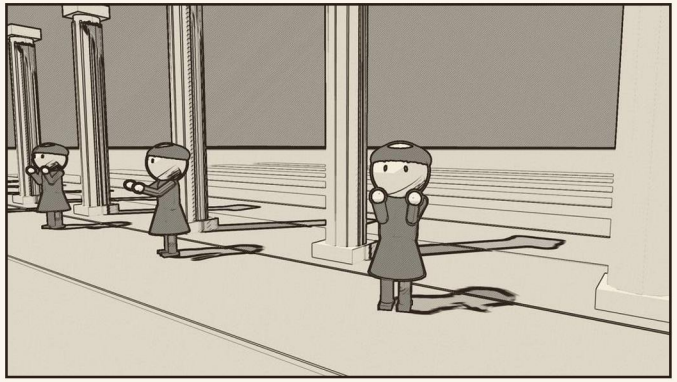
0.1 · 9.0s

VO Rome, the fifteenth of March, 44 BC. The most powerful man in the world walks into a meeting of the Senate.
FRAME Caesar in a purple-bordered toga walks up marble steps into the Curia of Pompey, morning light
MOTION low angle tracking behind him up the steps



0.2 · 4.2s

VO His name is Gaius Julius Caesar. Dictator for life.
FRAME Caesar's face, calm brows, laurel wreath; name callout
MOTION slow push in



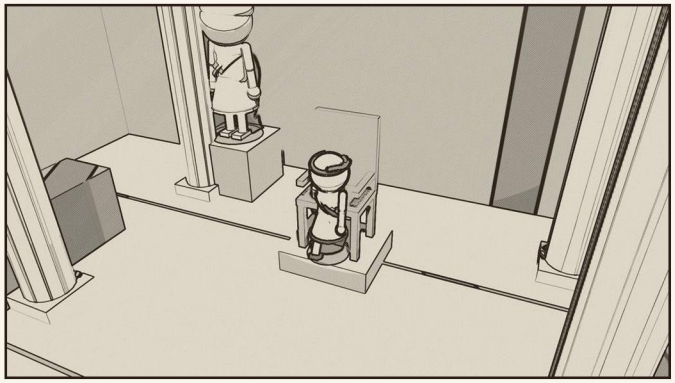
0.3 · 7.0s

VO Outside the door, a group of gladiators waits in the courtyard, trying not to be noticed.
FRAME Gladiators loitering among columns, helmets under arms
MOTION lateral dolly along the colonnade



0.4 · 8.6s

VO His closest ally, Mark Antony, should be at his side. But someone has stopped him at the door to talk.
FRAME Antony held in conversation outside by another senator, looking away from the door
MOTION over-the-shoulder from inside the doorway



0.5 · 7.4s

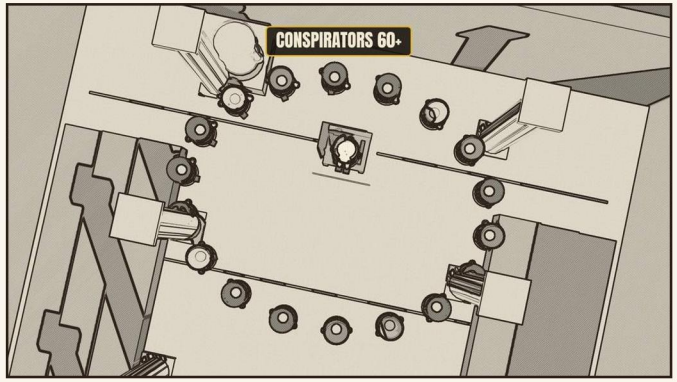
VO Caesar takes his seat on a golden chair at the front of the room. He is alone.
FRAME The golden chair, Caesar sits; the doors behind close
MOTION crane down to the chair



0.6 · 5.4s

VO Across the room, one senator stands up and starts walking toward him.
FRAME A senator rises from the benches; dozens of eyes follow
MOTION slow push past the benches

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 0 COLD OPEN

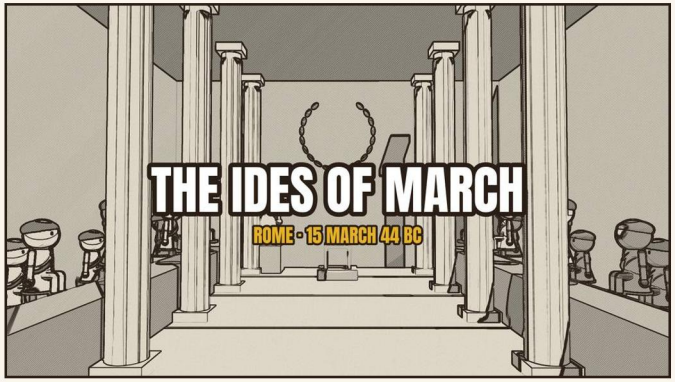


0.7 · 10.2s

VO In the next few minutes, more than sixty men will try to save the Roman Republic. And in doing it, they will destroy it.

FRAME Ring of togas closing around the chair, seen from above

MOTION top-down slow rotation



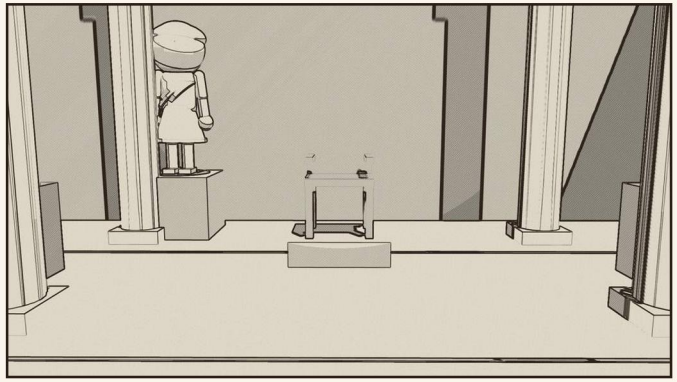
0.8 · 3.8s

VO This is the most famous killing in history.

FRAME "THE IDES OF MARCH" title slams over the Senate hall, laurel emblem

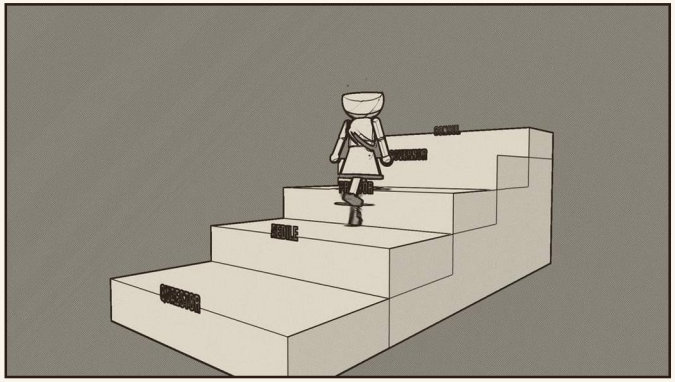
MOTION title slam, then slow push

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 1 TOO POWERFUL



1.1 · 5.0s

VO To understand how Caesar got here, we have to go back.
FRAME The golden chair fades to a young Caesar in a plain toga
MOTION slow dissolve push



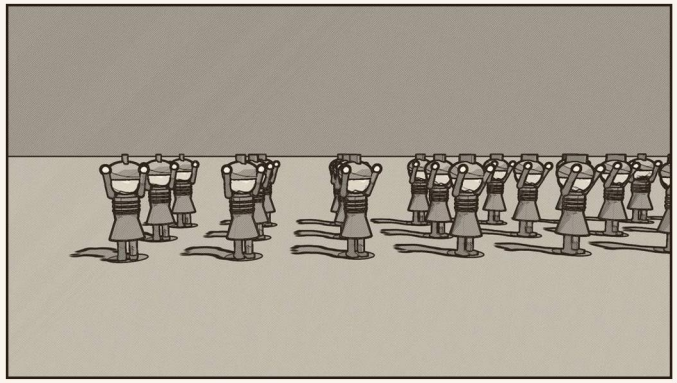
1.2 · 5.8s

VO Over almost forty years in politics, Caesar climbed to Rome's highest office. Consul.
FRAME Caesar climbing a staircase of office titles, "CONSUL" at the top
MOTION crane up the staircase



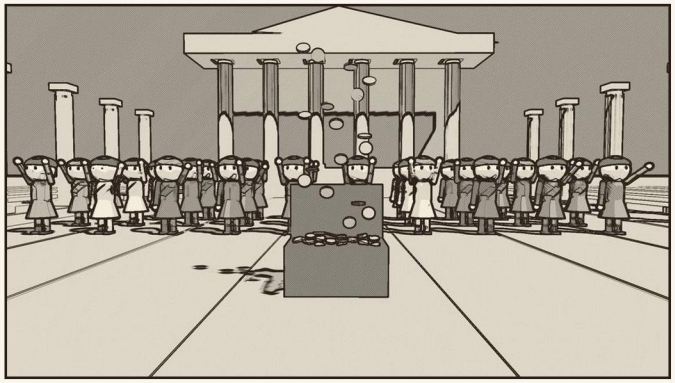
1.3 · 9.0s

VO As a general, he conquered all of Gaul. Today that is France, Belgium and parts of Switzerland, Germany and the Netherlands.
FRAME Parchment map; Gaul floods Roman red, modern names in small labels
MOTION crane over Gaul as it fills



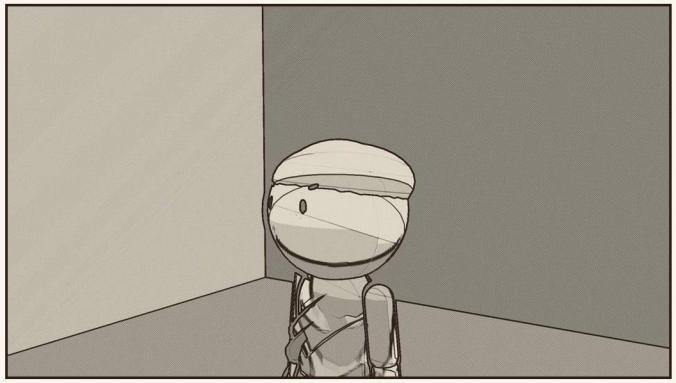
1.4 · 7.8s

VO He was a military genius, and charming with it. His legions were loyal to him, and only him.
FRAME Rows of legionaries turning to salute Caesar, not the Senate standard
MOTION lateral dolly down the ranks



1.5 · 8.6s

VO His wars made him enormously rich. And he spoke for ordinary Romans against the old elite. The people loved him.
FRAME Coins pour into a chest; crowd cheering in the Forum
MOTION push through the crowd



1.6 · 3.0s

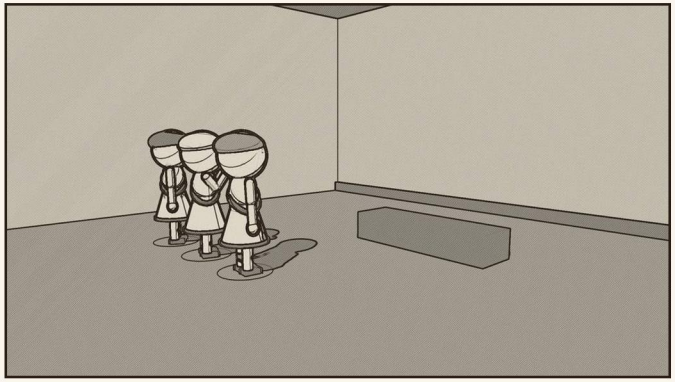
VO Maybe they loved him too much.
FRAME The cheering crowd seen from a Senate window, a stern senator watching
MOTION slow push on the senator's frown

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 1 TOO POWERFUL



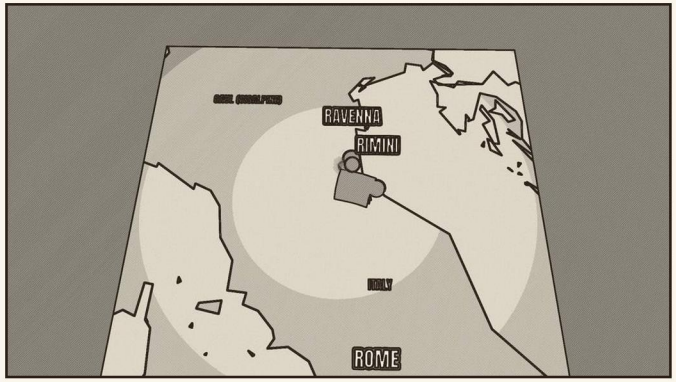
1.7 · 8.6s

VO In 49 BC, the Senate and Caesar's great rival, Pompey, order him to give up his army and come home.
FRAME Map: letter icon flies from Rome to Caesar in Gaul
MOTION follow the letter



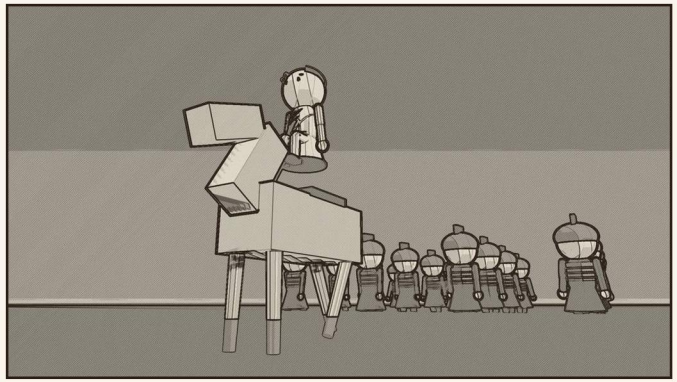
1.8 · 7.8s

VO Without his command, he would lose his legal protection. His enemies were waiting to put him on trial.
FRAME Courtroom with empty defendant's bench and waiting prosecutors
MOTION slow push on the empty bench



1.9 · 9.8s

VO So Caesar does something no Roman general is allowed to do. He crosses the Rubicon river into Italy, with a legion behind him.
FRAME Map close on northern Italy; the Rubicon line; a legion icon steps across it
MOTION push in on the crossing



1.10 · 8.2s

VO Roman law said generals had to leave their armies behind at that river. Crossing it with soldiers meant war.
FRAME Caesar on horseback in the shallow river, legion behind, mist
MOTION low angle from the water



1.11 · 10.2s

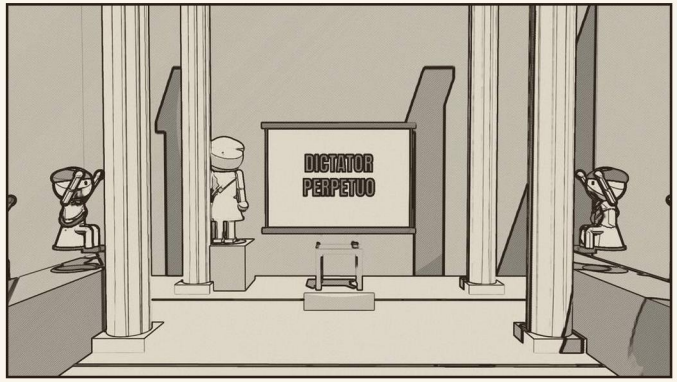
VO The civil war spreads across the whole Republic. In 48 BC, Caesar defeats Pompey in Greece. Pompey flees to Egypt and is killed there.
FRAME Map: battle icon at Pharsalus, Pompey's ship to Egypt, a dark X
MOTION follow the arrows



1.12 · 7.0s

VO The last of Pompey's armies is crushed in Spain in March 45 BC. Caesar has won.
FRAME Map: Munda in Spain flashes; the whole Republic turns Caesar red
MOTION crane back to show all of it

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 1 TOO POWERFUL



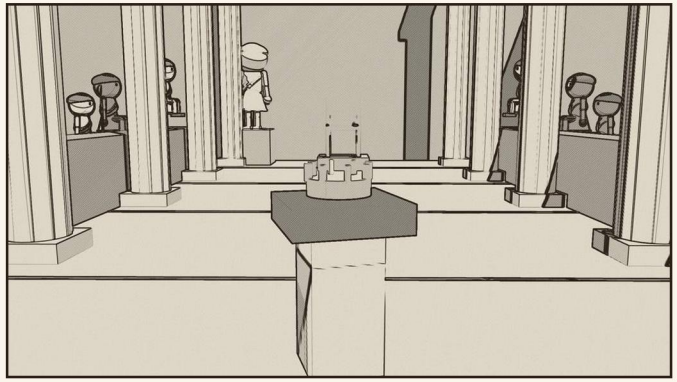
1.13 · 10.2s

VO The Senate that once tried to stop him now gives him everything. Consul again and again. Then, in February 44 BC, dictator for life.

FRAME Senators raising hands; a scroll unrolls "DICTATOR PERPETUO"

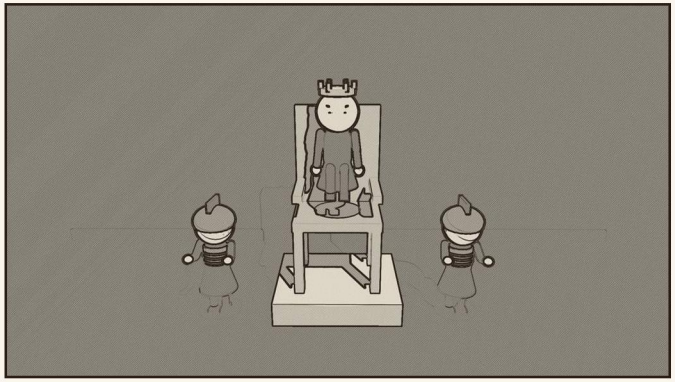
MOTION push in on the scroll

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 2 THE KING WHO WASN'T



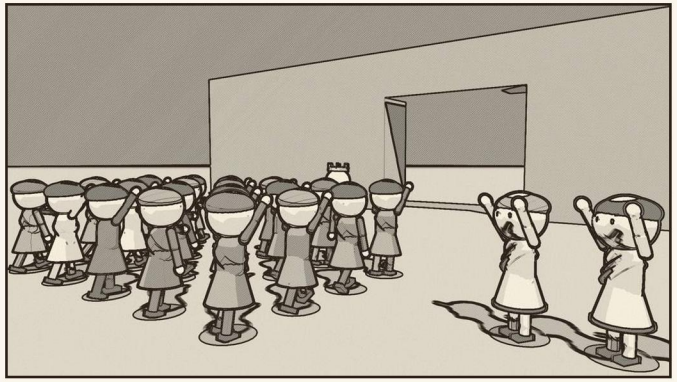
2.1 · 5.4s

VO Meanwhile, one word frightens Rome's old families more than any other. King.
FRAME A golden crown on a cushion, Senate hall in shadow behind
MOTION slow push on the crown



2.2 · 5.8s

VO Rome had kings once. The last was Tarquin the Proud, a cruel tyrant.
FRAME Tarquin on a throne, stern brows, guards on either side
MOTION crane down on the throne



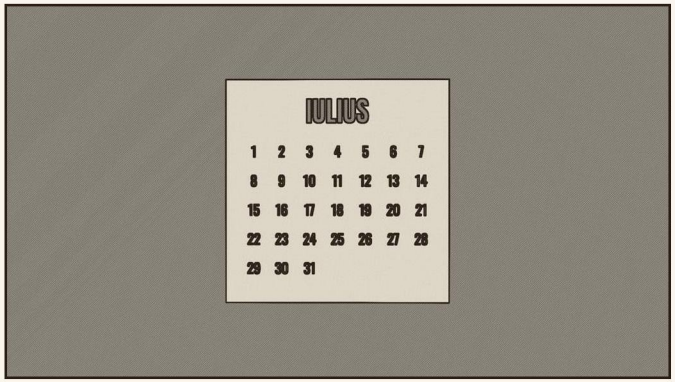
2.3 · 7.8s

VO Around 509 BC, the Romans threw him out, and swore that no king would ever rule Rome again.
FRAME Crowd pushing Tarquin out of the city gate; senators raising hands in an oath
MOTION tracking the crowd



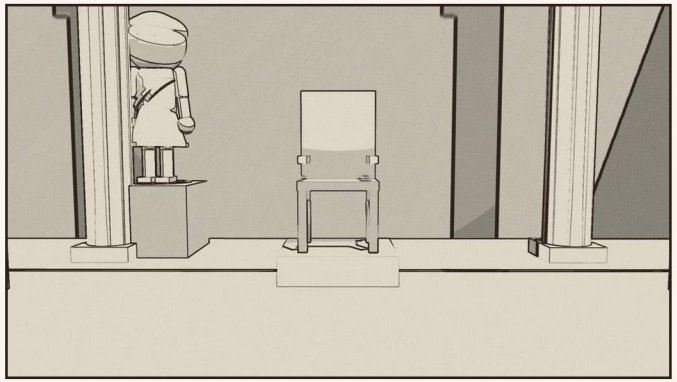
2.4 · 9.8s

VO Now it looks as if Caesar wants to be one. He wears royal purple and puts up statues of himself around the city.
FRAME Caesar in a purple toga beside a new statue of himself
MOTION orbit the statue



2.5 · 7.4s

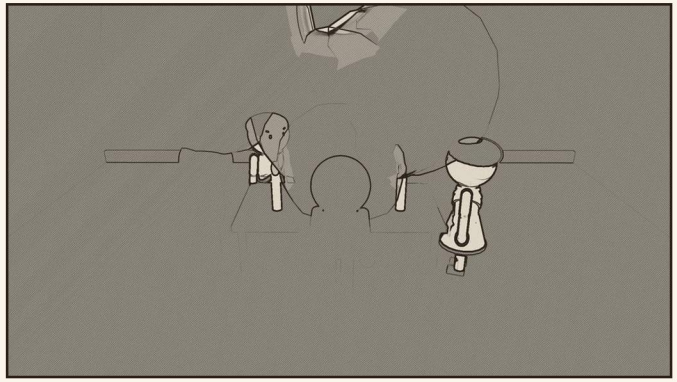
VO His allies rename the month of his birth, Quintilis, after him. Julius. We still call it July.
FRAME Calendar page flips from QUINTILIS to IULIUS to JULY
MOTION calendar flip



2.6 · 8.6s

VO He even has a golden chair made for him in the Senate. The same chair he is sitting on today.
FRAME The golden chair gleams; the camera links it to Act 0's chair
MOTION slow push

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 2 THE KING WHO WASN'T



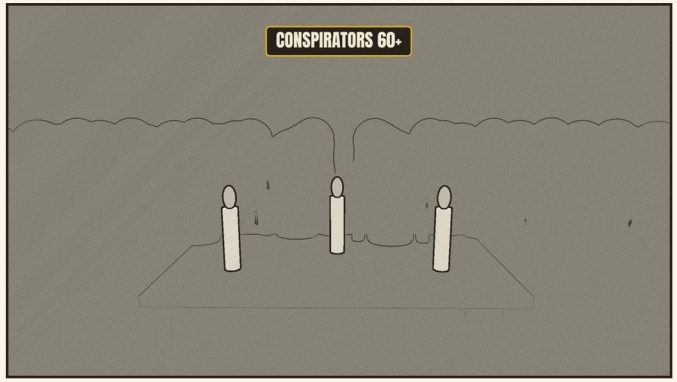
2.7 · 10.6s

VO For his enemies, Caesar is a threat to the Republic itself. They cannot beat him in battle. So they will have to find another way.

FRAME Shadowy figures in togas meeting by candlelight

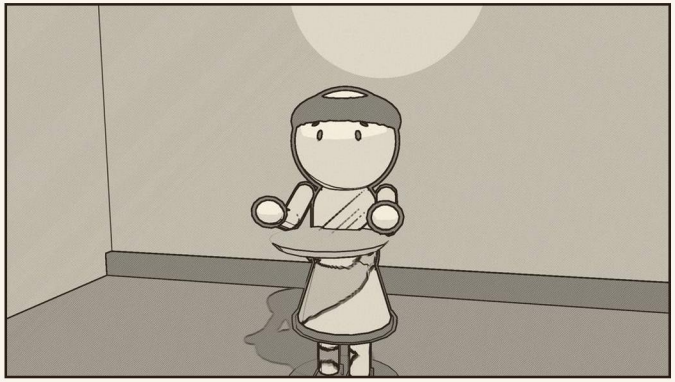
MOTION slow push through the candle smoke

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 3 THE CONSPIRACY



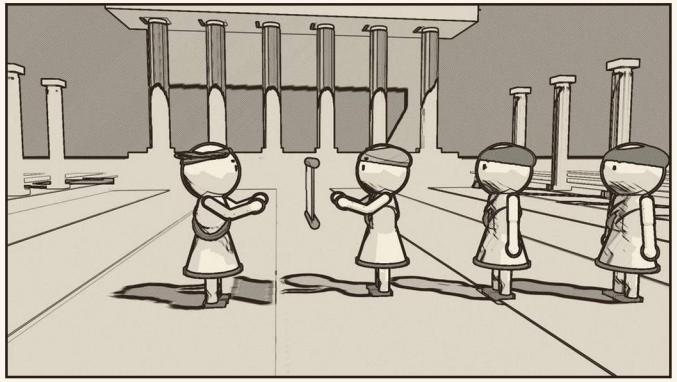
3.1 · 5.4s

VO About sixty men join the plot. They come from very different places.
FRAME Sixty silhouettes in togas fill a dark hall
MOTION crane up and back



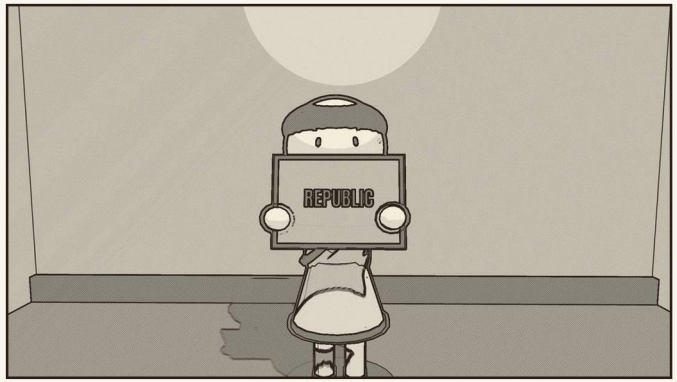
3.2 · 5.0s

VO Some are old allies who feel Caesar never rewarded them enough.
FRAME Senator with an empty reward plate
MOTION push in



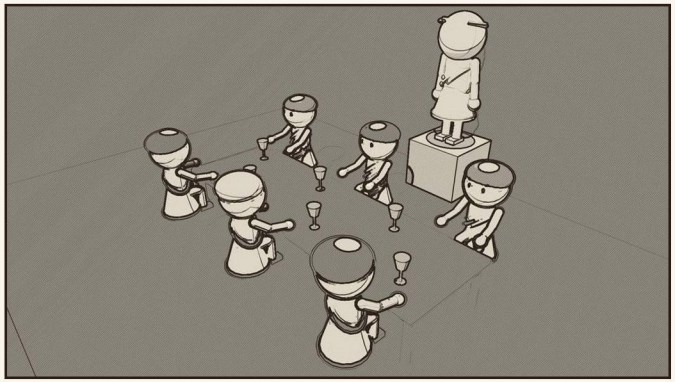
3.3 · 5.4s

VO Some fought against him for Pompey, and were pardoned by Caesar himself.
FRAME Former enemies receiving a pardon scroll from Caesar; red ink stamp "PARDONED"
MOTION lateral dolly



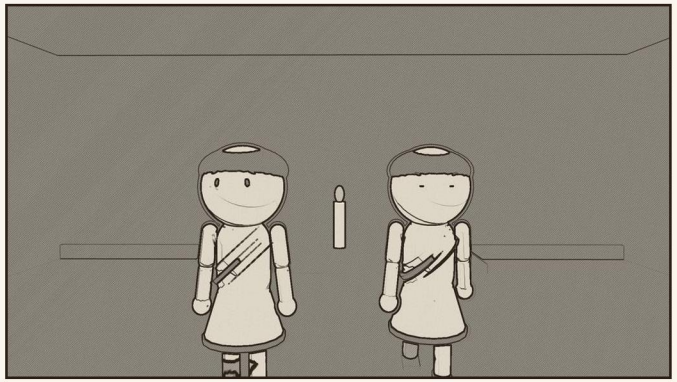
3.4 · 5.4s

VO A few simply believe in the Republic, and see a king coming.
FRAME A senator with a wax tablet reading "REPUBLIC"
MOTION slow push



3.5 · 9.0s

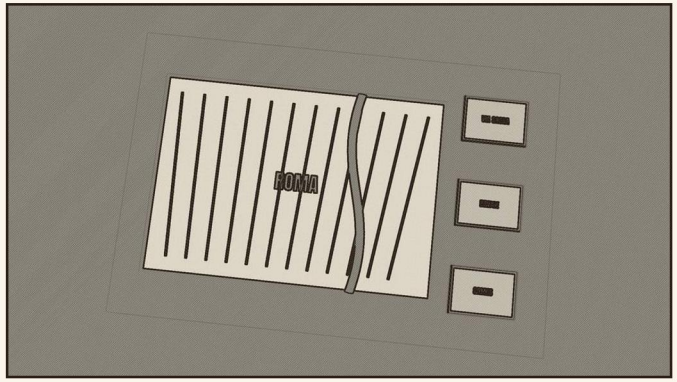
VO And most belong to the old aristocracy, who run the Senate and do not want to share power with one man.
FRAME Rich senators at a banquet table, frowning at Caesar's statue
MOTION crane over the table



3.6 · 3.8s

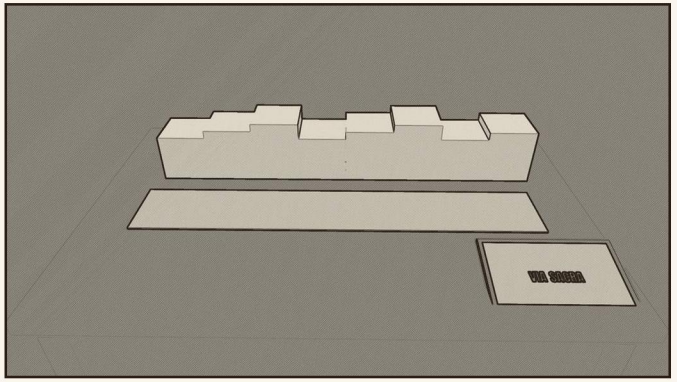
VO Their leaders include Marcus Brutus and Gaius Cassius.
FRAME Two figures step forward; name callouts
MOTION push in on both

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 3 THE CONSPIRACY



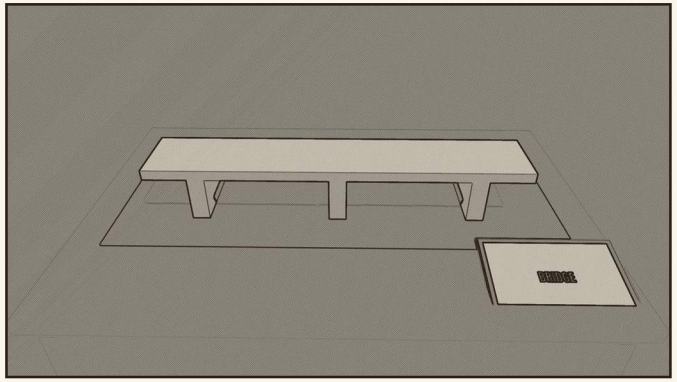
3.7 · 6.6s

VO For months they meet in secret. And they look at different ways to do it.
FRAME A table with a city map and three wax tablets
MOTION top-down push



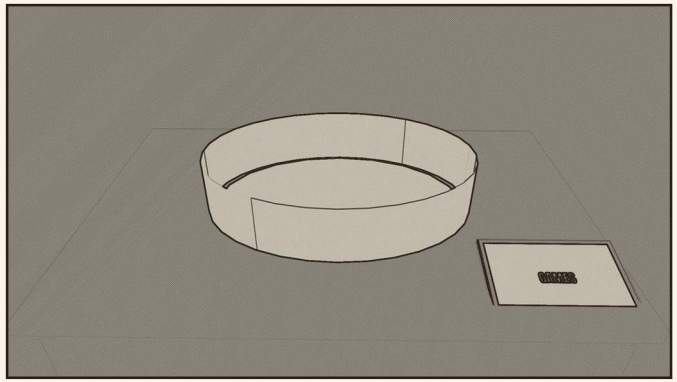
3.8 · 7.8s

VO Plan one. Attack him in the street, on the Via Sacra. Too public. His friends might be nearby.
FRAME Street scene on the Via Sacra, a red X stamps the tablet
MOTION push in, X stamp



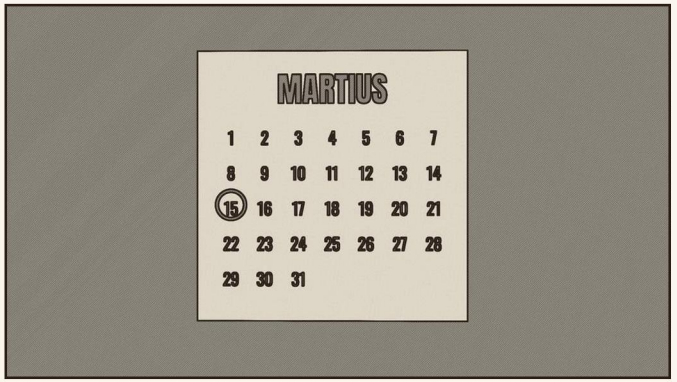
3.9 · 5.8s

VO Plan two. Throw him off a bridge, with armed men waiting below. Ambitious.
FRAME Tiny bridge model with tiny men underneath, a red X stamps it
MOTION top-down, X stamp



3.10 · 5.0s

VO Plan three. Hide among the gladiators at a show. Also rejected.
FRAME Arena model, red X stamps it
MOTION push in, X stamp



3.11 · 7.4s

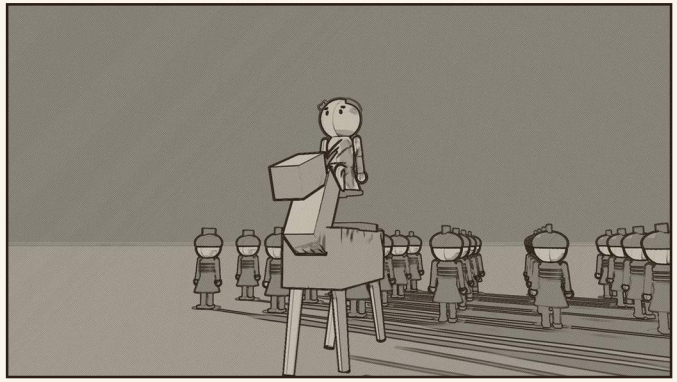
VO In the end they choose a meeting of the Senate on the fifteenth of March, the Ides.
FRAME Calendar with the 15th circled in red
MOTION push in on the circle



3.12 · 9.0s

VO Three days later, Caesar is leaving Rome on a huge new war in the east, against the Dacians and the Parthians.
FRAME Map: arrows from Rome toward Dacia and Parthia
MOTION follow the arrows east

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 3 THE CONSPIRACY



3.13 · 8.6s

VO Once he leaves, he will be out of reach for years, and he will come back with even more glory.
FRAME Caesar on horseback at the head of an army, sun behind
MOTION slow push



3.14 · 7.8s

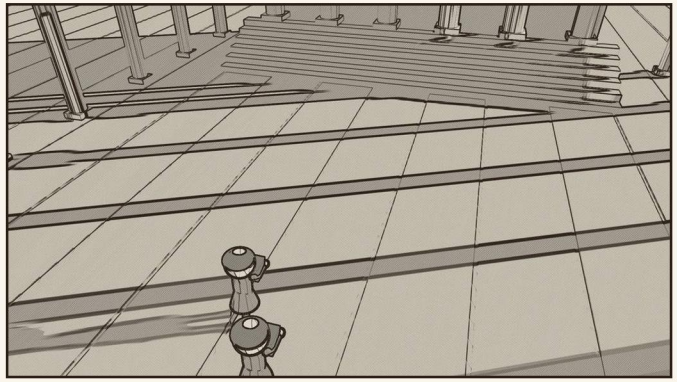
VO A Senate meeting is perfect. Weapons are not allowed inside, so no one will be armed. Except them.
FRAME Senate doorway with a sign of a crossed-out sword
MOTION push in on the sign



3.15 · 7.4s

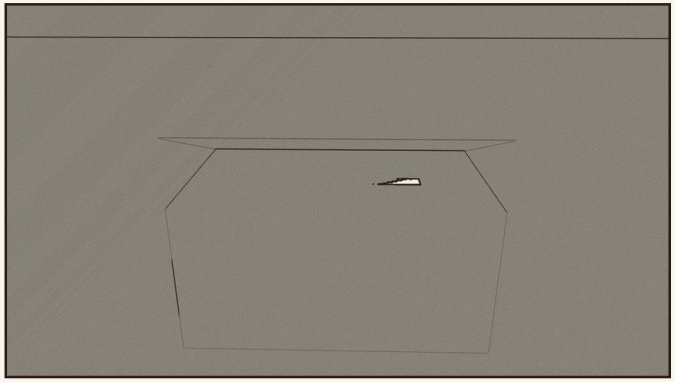
VO Most senators are loyal to Caesar. But few will jump in front of a blade for him.
FRAME Rows of senators looking nervous, glancing at each other
MOTION lateral dolly along the benches

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 4 THE TRAP



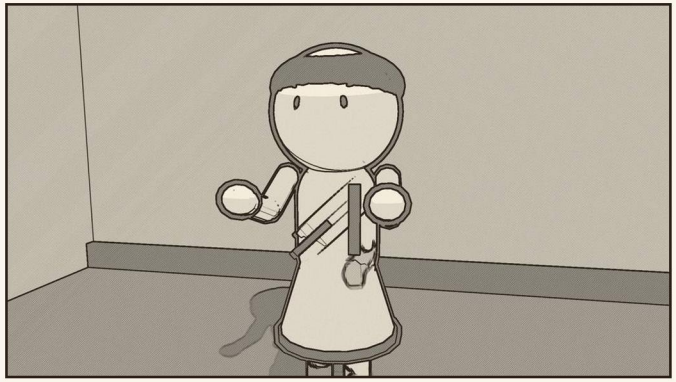
4.1 · 6.2s

VO On the morning of the fifteenth, daggers are carried into the Curia of Pompey.
FRAME Morning at the Curia, servants carry wooden boxes
MOTION crane down to the doorway



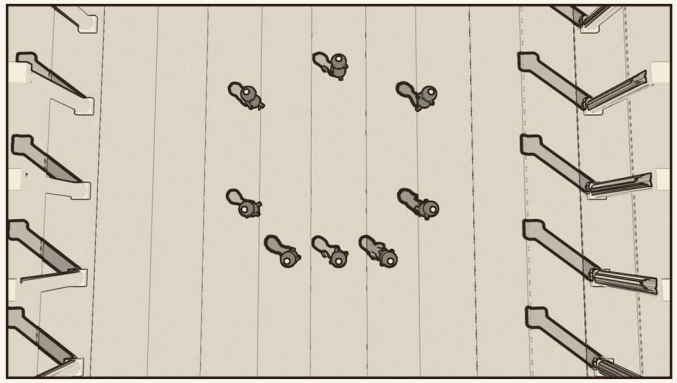
4.2 · 5.8s

VO They are hidden in the wooden boxes normally used to carry writing tablets.
FRAME Box lid opens a crack, a glint inside; lid closes
MOTION close push



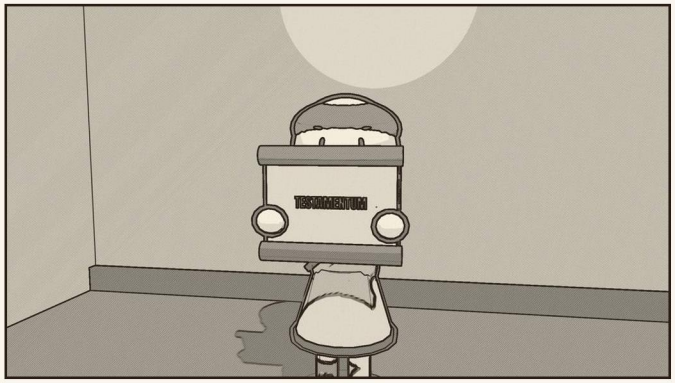
4.3 · 5.0s

VO The conspirators take them out and hide them under their togas.
FRAME A senator adjusts his toga, a dagger shape vanishes beneath the fold
MOTION slow push



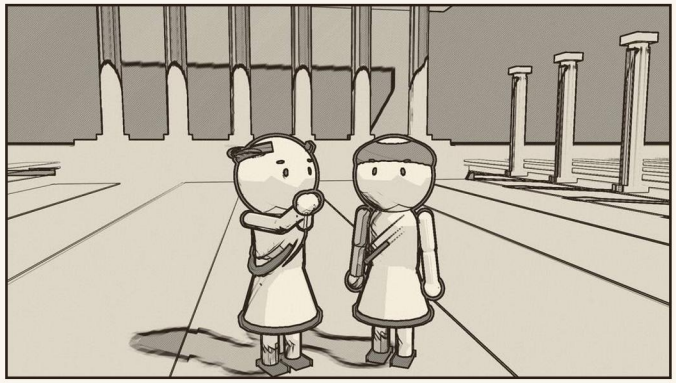
4.4 · 7.0s

VO Outside, the gladiators take their places by the exits. If Caesar runs, he won't get far.
FRAME Gladiators spread to the courtyard exits, top-down plan view
MOTION top-down crane



4.5 · 7.8s

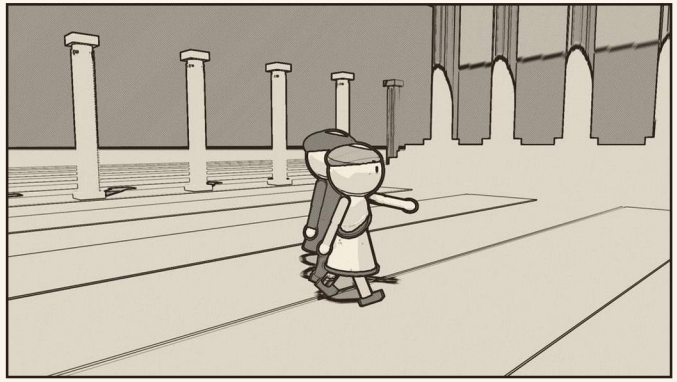
VO The gladiators belong to Decimus Brutus, one of Caesar's closest friends. A man named in Caesar's own will.
FRAME Decimus Brutus with the will scroll; name callout
MOTION push in on the scroll



4.6 · 5.8s

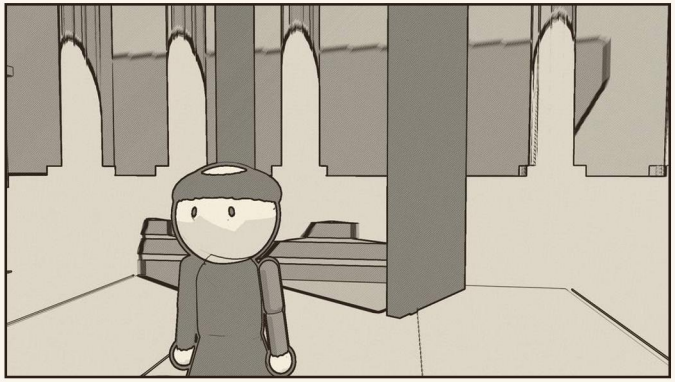
VO Caesar trusts him completely. He would never question why Decimus's gladiators are there.
FRAME Caesar and Decimus laughing together, Caesar's hand on his shoulder
MOTION slow orbit

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 4 THE TRAP



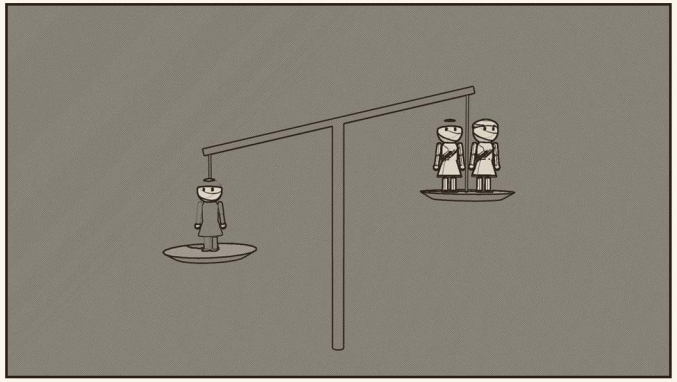
4.7 · 7.8s

VO And when Caesar arrives with Mark Antony, a senator named Gaius Trebonius takes Antony aside for a chat.
FRAME Trebonius steering Antony away from the door
MOTION tracking the two



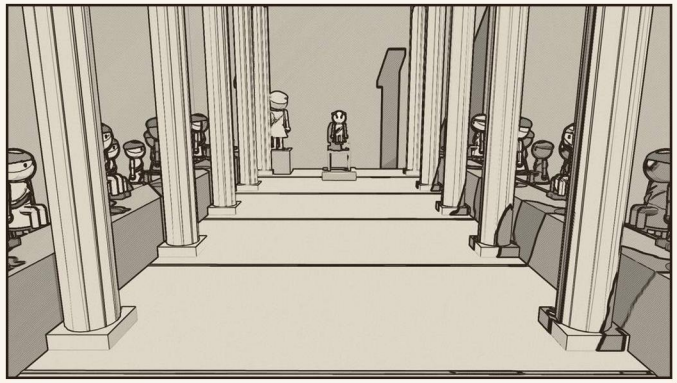
4.8 · 7.0s

VO Antony is big, strong, and completely loyal. The plotters made sure he would not be inside.
FRAME Antony's broad shoulders in frame as the doors close behind him
MOTION push in on the closing doors



4.9 · 9.8s

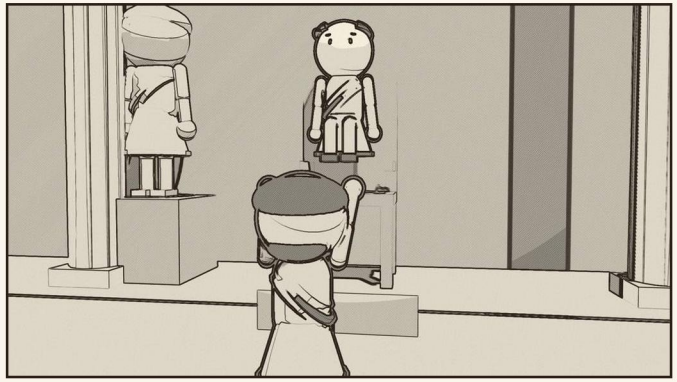
VO They had thought about killing Antony too. They decided against it. Killing Caesar alone would look like punishing a tyrant, not a massacre.
FRAME Two scales: one figure vs two figures; the single figure stays
MOTION scale animation



4.10 · 5.0s

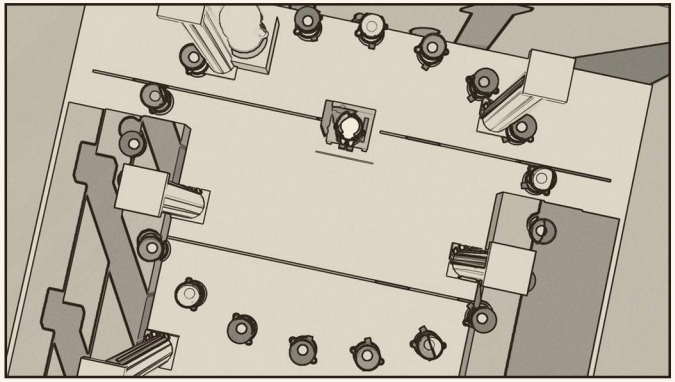
VO The stage is set. All they need now is a signal.
FRAME Wide shot of the hall, Caesar on his chair, sixty togas still
MOTION slow crane up

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 5 THE IDES OF MARCH



5.1 · 9.8s

VO The signal is a senator called Tillius Cimber. He walks up to Caesar and begs him to bring his brother home from exile.
FRAME Cimber kneels before the chair, hands raised
MOTION slow push from behind Cimber



5.2 · 6.2s

VO Dozens of senators stand up and crowd around, all pleading for the same thing.
FRAME Togas rise from the benches and close in like a tide
MOTION top-down rotation as the ring tightens



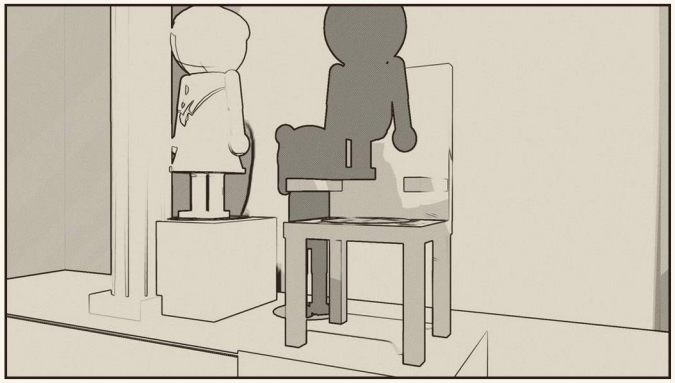
5.3 · 5.4s

VO Then Cimber grabs Caesar's toga and pulls it down off his shoulders.
FRAME Cimber grabs the toga; Caesar's surprised brows
MOTION close push



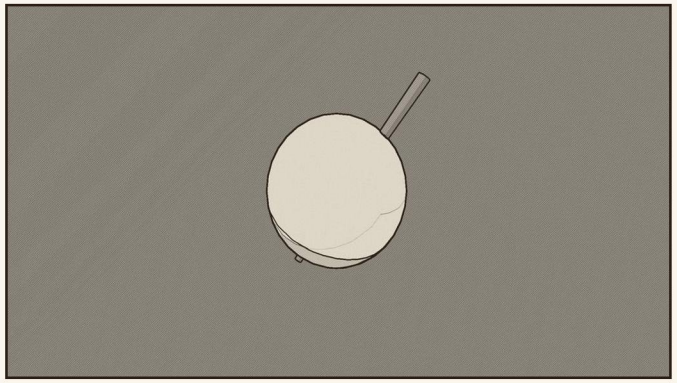
5.4 · 3.4s

VO Caesar shouts in shock. This is violence.
FRAME Caesar half-standing, mouth open
MOTION quick push in



5.5 · 5.8s

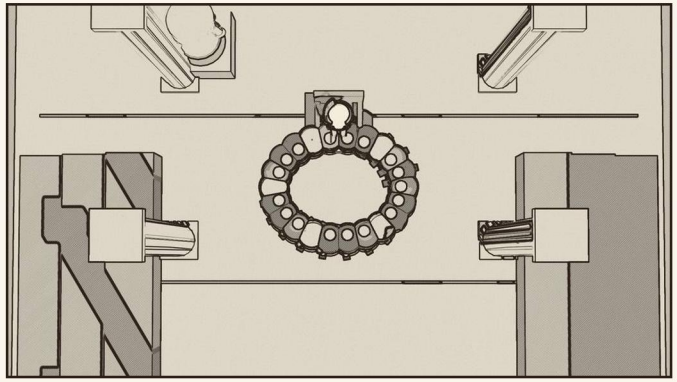
VO Behind him, a senator named Casca strikes first. The blow only grazes him.
FRAME Casca's silhouette behind the chair, a dark shape; cut to black on the strike
MOTION cut to black



5.6 · 11.8s

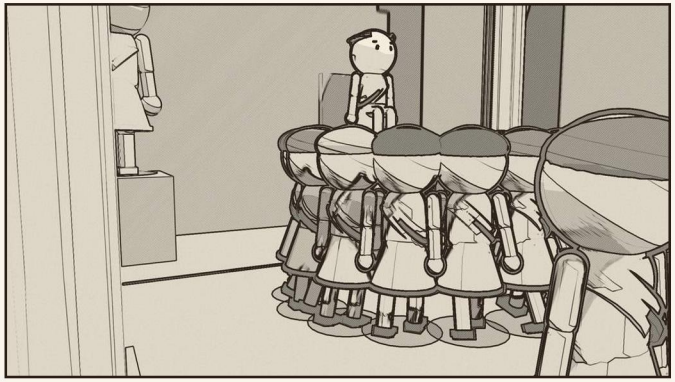
VO Caesar spins around and, according to one ancient writer, stabs Casca in the arm with his stylus. His pen. Sadly, the pen is not mightier than the sword.
FRAME Close on a writing stylus in Caesar's mitten hand; a tiny "OUCH" in comic font
MOTION push in on the stylus

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 5 THE IDES OF MARCH



5.7 · 4.2s

VO In seconds, Caesar disappears inside a crowd of togas.
FRAME The ring of togas closes over the chair from above; no blades visible
MOTION top-down, camera sinks



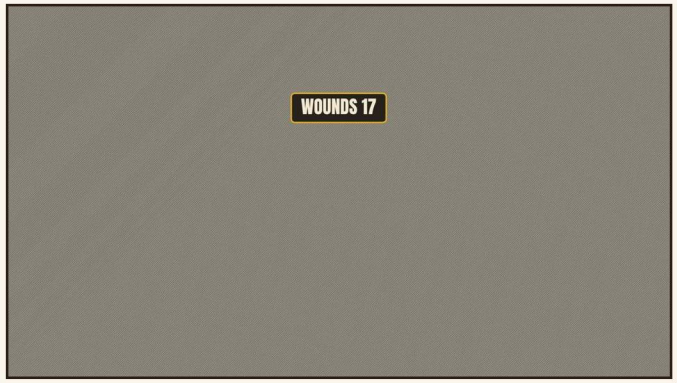
5.8 · 6.6s

VO Two of his loyal friends try to push through to him. They are pushed back.
FRAME Two senators shoved back at the edge of the crowd
MOTION lateral dolly



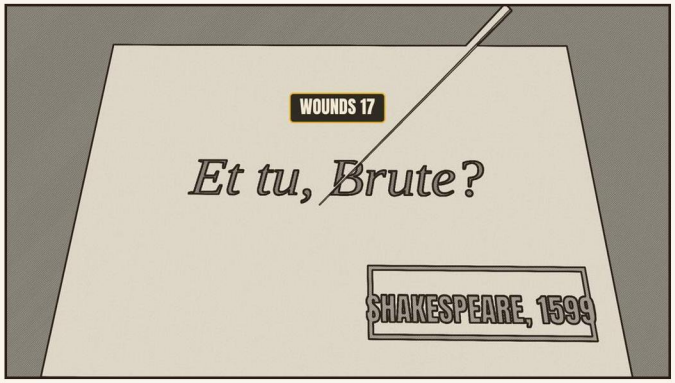
5.9 · 5.0s

VO Marcus Brutus is in the crowd too, and strikes as well.
FRAME Brutus's face among the togas, then cut to black
MOTION slow push, cut to black



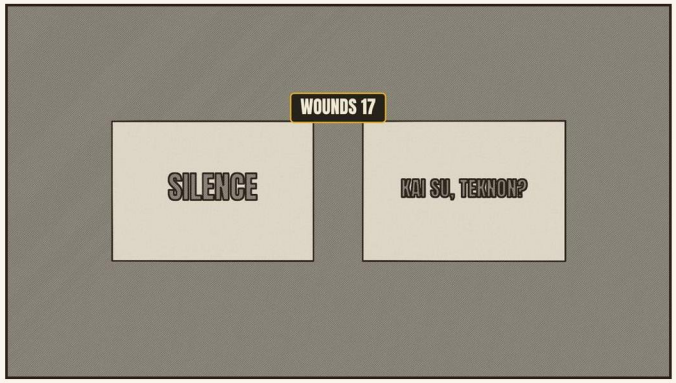
5.10 · 9.0s

VO Caesar is struck twenty-three times. A doctor later said only one of those wounds was fatal, the second, to his chest.
FRAME Black screen with a white tally counting to 23; doctor's note card
MOTION tally tick



5.11 · 9.0s

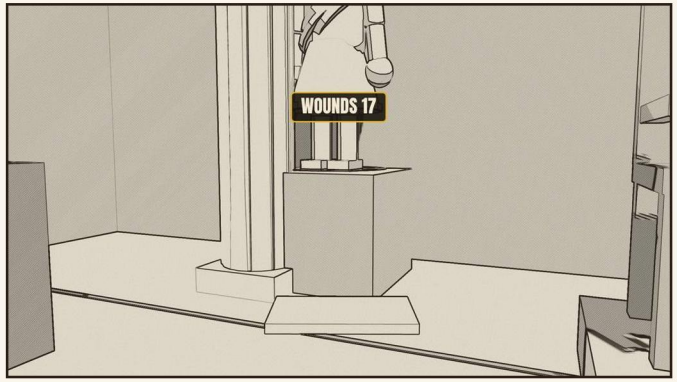
VO And his famous last words? "Et tu, Brute," "you too, Brutus," comes from Shakespeare, written more than sixteen hundred years later.
FRAME Quill writing "ET TU, BRUTE?" on paper, a "SHAKESPEARE, 1599" stamp
MOTION push in on the quill



5.12 · 8.6s

VO One ancient writer says Caesar said nothing at all. Others say his last words were in Greek. "You too, child?"
FRAME Two cards: "SILENCE" and "KAI SU, TEKNON?"
MOTION card flips

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 5 THE IDES OF MARCH



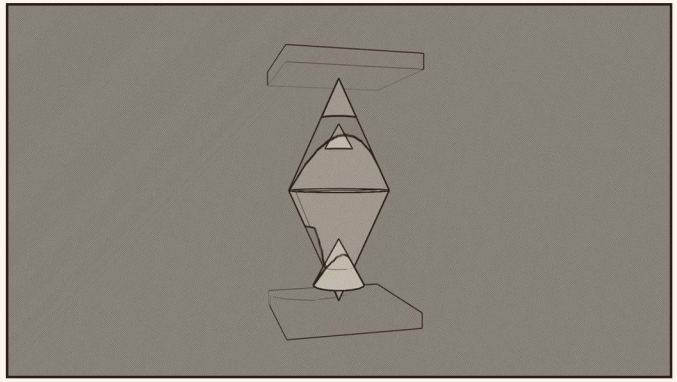
5.13 · 9.0s

VO He falls at the foot of a statue. A statue of Pompey, the rival he defeated, and refused to tear down.

FRAME The marble statue of Pompey looking down at the empty golden chair; a fallen toga at its base, no blood

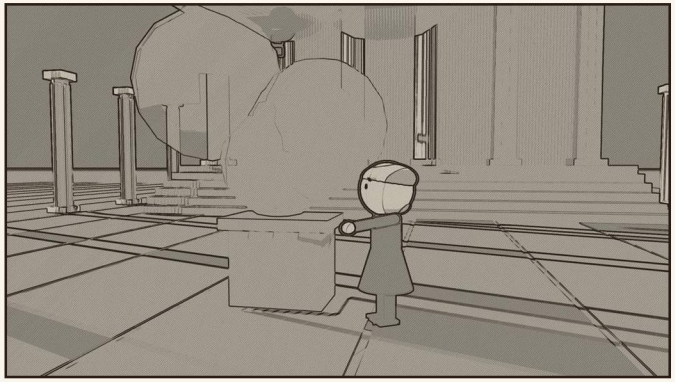
MOTION slow crane up the statue

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 6 THE WARNINGS



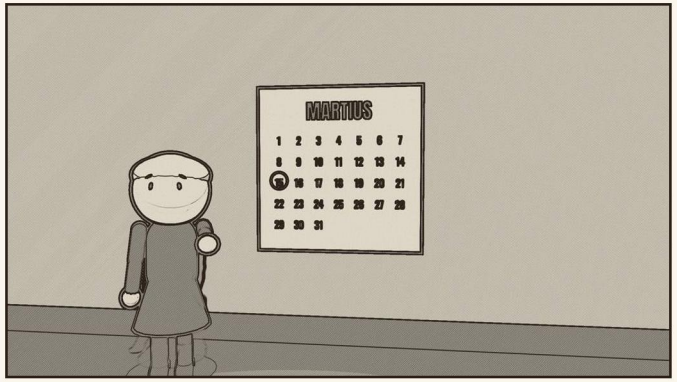
6.1 · 7.8s

VO Caesar should have seen it coming. Ancient writers say the warnings had been piling up for a month.
FRAME An hourglass turning back; sand flows upward
MOTION slow push



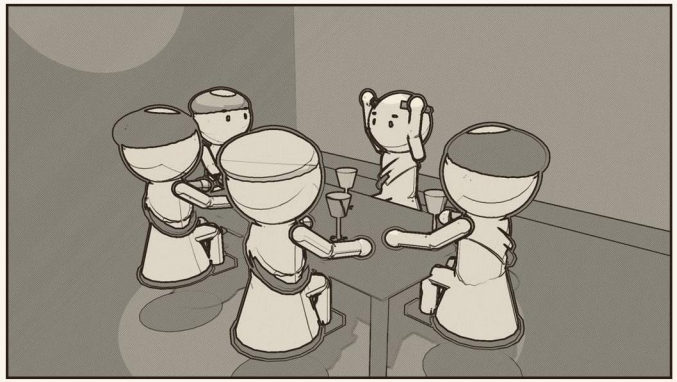
6.2 · 8.2s

VO In February, a soothsayer named Spurinna made a sacrifice for him. The animal, it was said, had no heart.
FRAME An altar with smoke, Spurinna reading the omens; a red question mark
MOTION push in on Spurinna



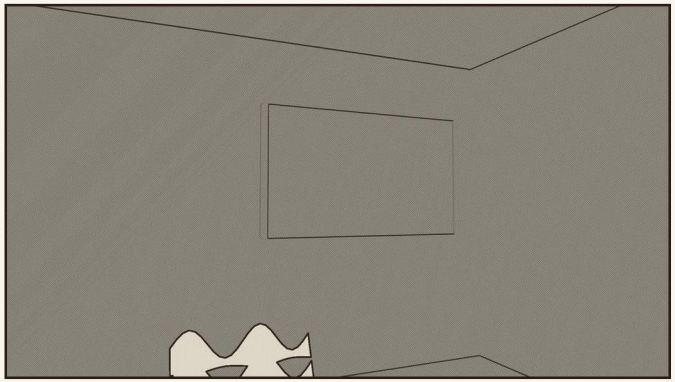
6.3 · 8.6s

VO Spurinna warned him his life was in danger, and that it would come no later than the Ides of March.
FRAME Spurinna pointing at a calendar, 15 circled
MOTION push in on the calendar



6.4 · 8.6s

VO On the night before, at dinner, the talk turned to the best kind of death. Caesar said, "A sudden one."
FRAME Dinner table, goblets, Caesar raising a hand
MOTION slow orbit around the table



6.5 · 6.2s

VO That night, the doors and windows of his bedroom flew open all at once.
FRAME Bedroom, shutters bang open, curtains blow in
MOTION quick push



6.6 · 10.2s

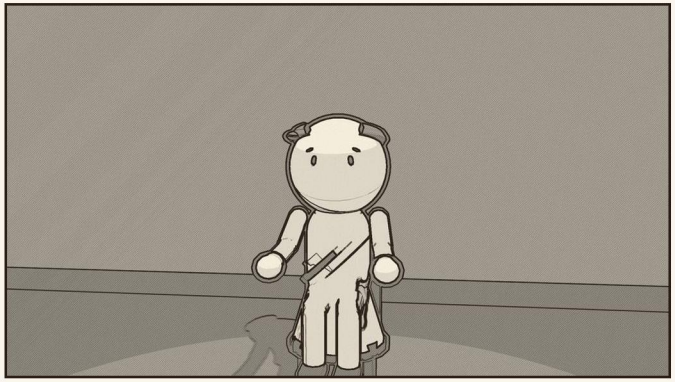
VO His wife, Calpurnia, cried in her sleep. In the morning she begged him not to go. She had dreamed she was holding his body.
FRAME Calpurnia clutching Caesar's arm at dawn
MOTION over-the-shoulder on Calpurnia

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 6 THE WARNINGS



6.7 · 7.4s

VO Caesar was not very superstitious. But he called his own priests. Every sign they read was bad.
FRAME Priests shaking their heads over an altar
MOTION lateral dolly



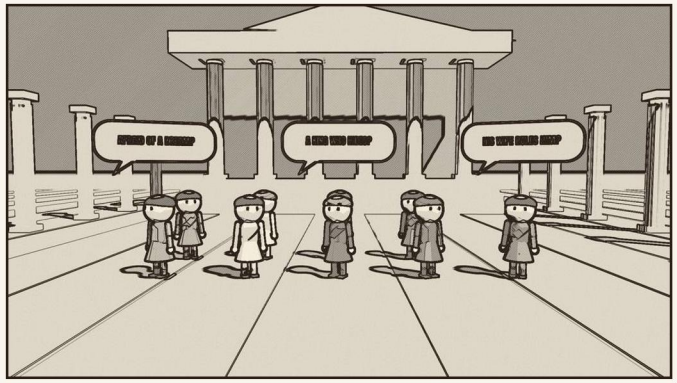
6.8 · 3.0s

VO So he decided not to go.
FRAME Caesar sits back down, takes off his laurel
MOTION slow push



6.9 · 10.2s

VO Then his friend Decimus Brutus came to the house. You called this meeting, he said. Will you really cancel it because of a dream?
FRAME Decimus at the doorway, persuasive hands
MOTION push in on Decimus



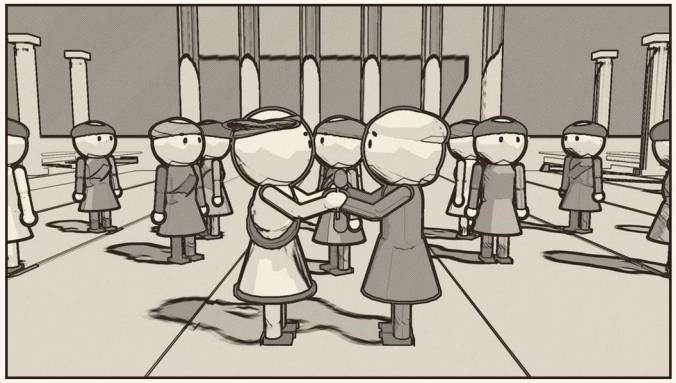
6.10 · 6.6s

VO What would people say? That the dictator of Rome was afraid of his wife's dreams.
FRAME Imaginary gossip bubbles over Roman heads
MOTION bubbles pop in



6.11 · 3.0s

VO So Caesar went.
FRAME Caesar puts the laurel back on and walks out
MOTION tracking behind him



6.12 · 10.6s

VO On the way, a teacher named Artemidorus pushed through the crowd and handed him a scroll. Read this now, he said. It is about you.
FRAME Artemidorus pressing a scroll into Caesar's hand in a busy street
MOTION push in on the scroll

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 6 THE WARNINGS



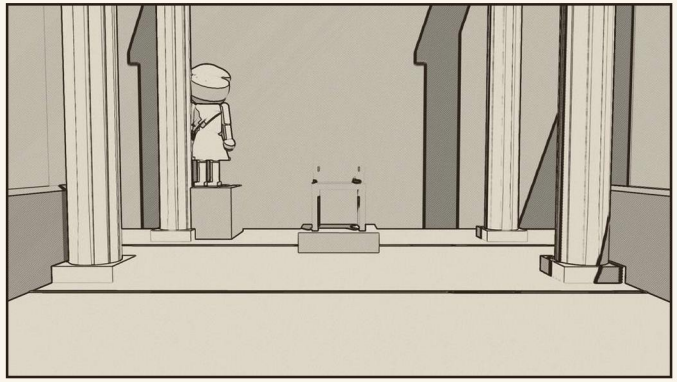
6.13 · 9.8s

VO It is said the scroll named the plot. Caesar never read it. He was still holding it when he walked into the Curia.

FRAME Scroll in Caesar's hand, unopened, as the Curia doors close

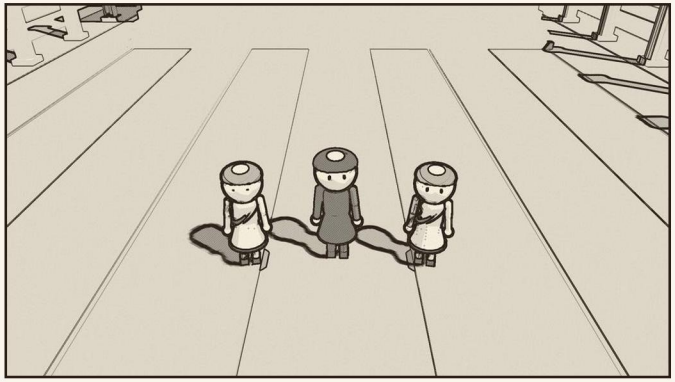
MOTION slow push to the doors

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 7 THE MASK



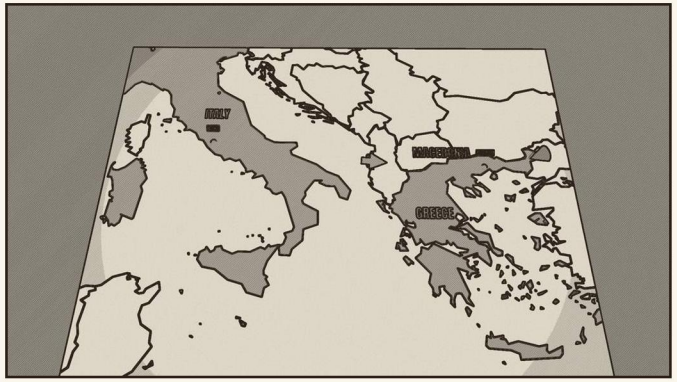
7.1 · 8.6s

VO Meanwhile, the killers thought they had saved the Republic. Instead, they had made a hole in the middle of it.
FRAME Empty golden chair in a silent hall
MOTION slow push



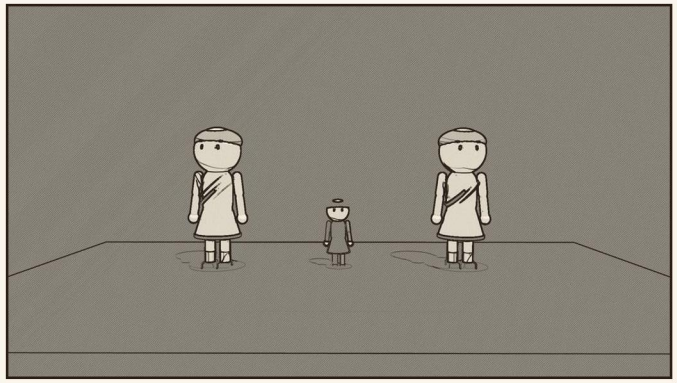
7.2 · 6.6s

VO Caesar's adopted son, Octavian, and his ally Mark Antony joined with the general Marcus Lepidus.
FRAME Three figures side by side; name callouts
MOTION crane down



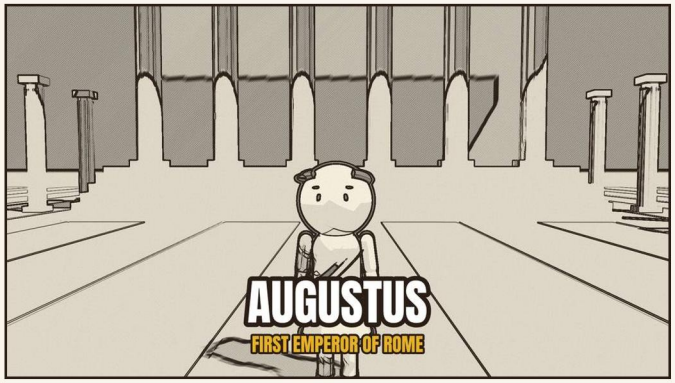
7.3 · 7.8s

VO Together they hunted the assassins down. In 42 BC, Brutus and Cassius were defeated at Philippi, in Greece.
FRAME Map: armies meet at Philippi
MOTION push in on Philippi



7.4 · 4.6s

VO More war followed, until only one man was left. Octavian.
FRAME Last figure standing on a stage as others fade
MOTION slow push



7.5 · 8.6s

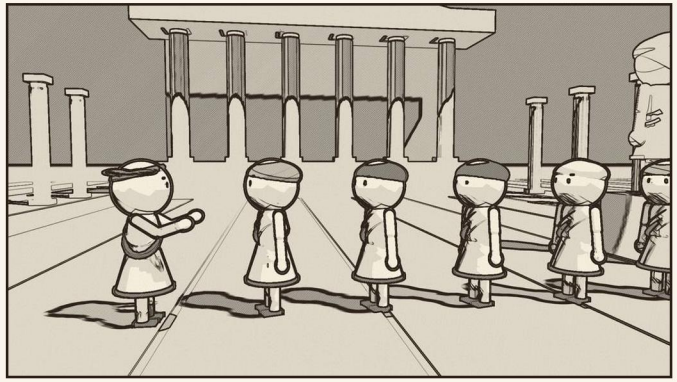
VO In 27 BC, the Senate gave him a new name, Augustus. He became Rome's first emperor. The Republic was over.
FRAME Octavian crowned with laurel, title "AUGUSTUS"
MOTION title slam



7.6 · 3.4s

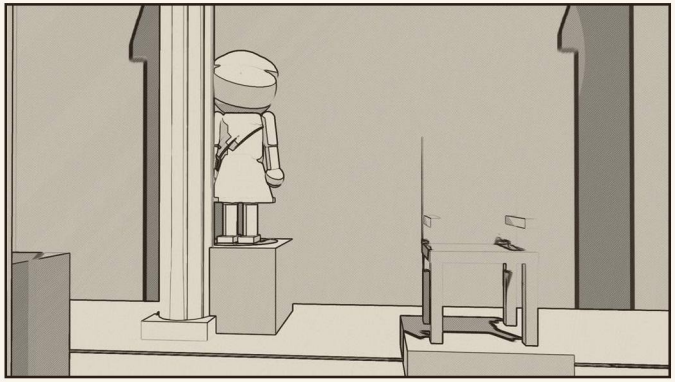
VO Augustus did not make his father's mistakes.
FRAME Augustus looking at Caesar's statue
MOTION slow push

THE IDES OF MARCH: STORYBOARD V1 · ACT 7 THE MASK



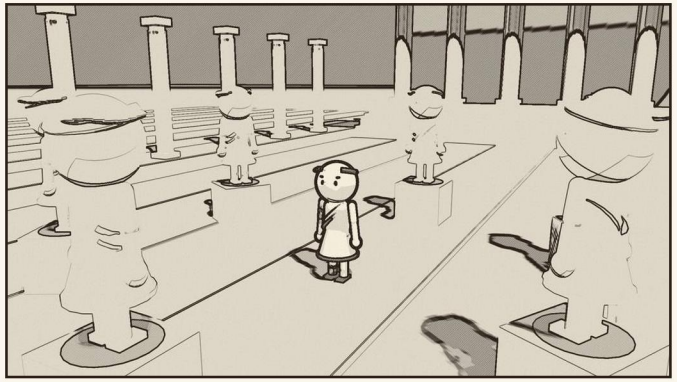
7.7 · 7.4s

VO Caesar pardoned his enemies. He promoted them. He gave them honours. He even left Pompey's statues standing.
FRAME Caesar handing pardons to men who later appear in the plot; statue of Pompey
MOTION lateral dolly



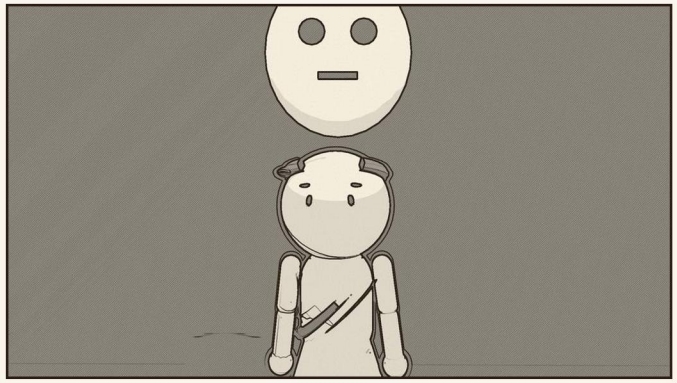
7.8 · 3.4s

VO His mercy may be what killed him.
FRAME The statue of Pompey over the empty chair
MOTION slow push



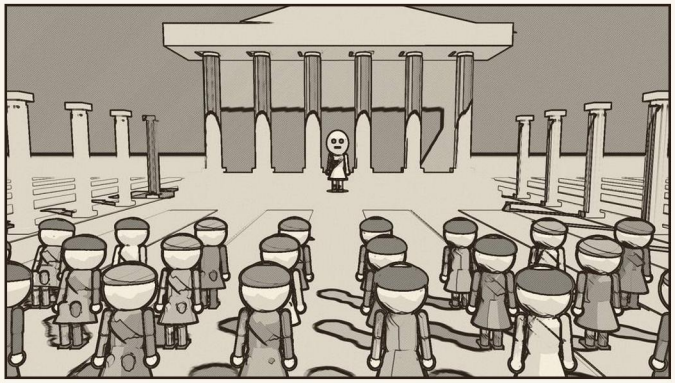
7.9 · 7.8s

VO Caesar was hated, but not feared. He showed his power openly, and made no effort to hide it.
FRAME Caesar in purple surrounded by statues of himself
MOTION orbit



7.10 · 9.4s

VO The historian John Balsdon put it this way. The next ruler of Rome would have to wear a republican mask, however false.
FRAME A theatre mask of a Roman senator lowered over Augustus's face
MOTION slow push on the mask



7.11 · 3.4s

VO Augustus wore that mask for forty years.
FRAME Augustus with the mask, crowds bowing
MOTION slow crane up



7.12 · 6.2s

VO If you want more stories like this, subscribe. See you in the next one.
FRAME End card with subscribe button
MOTION card slide